



# MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



## SACRED TEXT

*evam sa yātyate tatra bahūnabdānsuduḥkhitaḥ |  
tato viśṛṣṭo bhūyaśca ucchrayānpratipadyate || 7 ||  
taṃ hi gacchanti puruṣāḥ surāpā dharmadeśakāḥ |  
pitrhā mātṛhā caiva bhrātṛhā guruhā tathā || 8 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 46, Verses 7-8

## GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The passage describes a soul enduring immense hardship for countless years, only to eventually be released and rise again, suggesting a journey through lower realms followed by a return to higher states. This isn't simply about punishment; it's a depiction of the soul working through the repercussions of its actions, a necessary phase for purification and eventual liberation.

The verses then detail the types of individuals who find themselves in such a predicament: those who indulge in intoxicants, those who distort or misrepresent dharma (righteousness), and those who have committed grave sins against their parents, siblings, or teachers. These are not merely acts of transgression, but represent a severing of fundamental bonds and a disregard for the sacredness of life and learning. The text is not advocating literal interpretations of hell, but illustrating the inner torment and spiritual stagnation that results from such actions.

In modern life, this passage serves as a powerful reminder of the interconnectedness of our actions and their consequences. When you act with malice, deceit, or disrespect, you create a ripple effect that ultimately harms yourself. The "hell" described isn't a physical place, but the internal state of suffering, isolation, and regret that arises from negative karma. Conversely, when you cultivate virtues like compassion, honesty, and reverence, you pave the way for inner peace and spiritual growth.

The Skandapurāṇa encourages you to examine your own actions and motivations. Are you upholding dharma in your daily life, or are you compromising your integrity for personal gain? Are you nurturing your relationships with loved ones and mentors, or are you neglecting their needs and wisdom? By consciously choosing to align your actions with dharma, you can break free from the cycle of suffering and move towards a more fulfilling and meaningful existence. The path to liberation is not about avoiding punishment, but about cultivating inner transformation through virtuous living.

## REFLECTION FOR TODAY

*What small, conscious change can you make today to better align your actions with dharma and cultivate greater inner peace?*